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Child Custody and Parenting Time

Learn about the types of child custody and parenting time orders, who can file for child custody, and how to file or change child custody orders.

When parents are separating, they may disagree about issues regarding their child. When the child is under 18, one or both parents can ask the court to make decisions for them by getting a [court order](#) for [child custody](#) or [parenting time](#). For information about custody when you're not a parent, please see [Guardianship](#) of Minors.

Filing for custody

Learn about eligibility, the filing process, and how to get an immediate order.

[Who can file for child custody?](#) (<https://www.mass.gov/info-details/find-out-who-can-file-for-child-custody>)

[File for child custody or parenting time](#) (<https://www.mass.gov/info-details/filing-for-child-custody-or-parenting-time-in-massachusetts>)

[Get an immediate child custody or parenting time order](#)
(<https://www.mass.gov/how-to/get-an-immediate-child-custody-or-parenting-time-order>)

How it works

Learn about the types of custody arrangements, how the court decides, and options if you have been abused.

Types of child custody arrangements (<https://www.mass.gov/info-details/learn-about-the-types-of-child-custody-arrangements>)

How child custody or parenting time is decided (<https://www.mass.gov/info-details/learn-about-how-child-custody-or-parenting-time-is-decided>)

Child custody and parenting time options when you've been abused (<https://www.mass.gov/info-details/child-custody-and-parenting-time-options-when-youve-been-abused>)

Changing an order

Request to change a child custody or parenting time order (<https://www.mass.gov/how-to/request-to-change-a-child-custody-or-parenting-time-order>)

Child custody modification forms (<https://www.mass.gov/lists/probate-and-family-court-forms-for-modifications>)

Resources

[Collapse all](#)

Information for unmarried parents, and the laws on custody and parenting. (3)

Probate and Family Court forms for actions involving parentage of children and child support, custody, and parenting time for unmarried parents (<https://www.mass.gov/lists/probate-and-family-court-forms-for-actions-involving-parentage-of-children-and-child-support-custody-and-parenting-time-for-unmarried-parents>)

Massachusetts law about child custody and parenting time

(<https://www.mass.gov/info-details/massachusetts-law-about-child-custody-and-parenting-time>)

Glossary of court terms (<https://www.mass.gov/info-details/glossary-of-court-terms>)

Contact Information

Probate and Family Court locations

Online

Probate and Family Court locations (</orgs/probate-and-family-court/locations>)

Locations

Click or tap INSIDE map to move the map



Leaflet (<https://leafletjs.com>) | Source: **MassGIS** (<https://www.mass.gov/service-details/about-massgis>)

A list of court locations where you can file for child custody and parenting time

**FIND COURT
LOCATIONS**

(/CHILD-CUSTODY-AND-PARENTING-TIME/LOCATIONS)

Related Services

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